

Texas WIC Health and Human Services Commission

Effective April 1, 2026

Policy No. FD:10.0

Issuing Food Packages for the Mother/Infant Dyad

Purpose

To establish procedures for issuing food packages to the Mother/Infant dyad.

Authority

State Policy

Policy

Mother and infant packages must be prescribed according to the amount the mother is breastfeeding or the amount of formula provided. Packages must be prescribed by a Certifying Authority (CA) or WIC Certification Specialist (WCS).

Definitions

Electronic Benefit Account (EBA) - the account where food benefits are being held for redemption.

Procedures

- I. When issuing mother/infant food packages, local agency (LA) staff must explain the differences in food package benefits among each of the eligible food packages. A woman may indicate her preference for and be allowed to change to a food package that best suits her needs. Refer to [FD:12.0 Food Packages](#) for food package descriptions and [FD:12.1 Food Package Substitutions, Tailoring and Exchanges](#) for procedures for exchanging food packages.
- II. Staff must assess breastfeeding status of breastfeeding infant participants at time of each issuance. If the infant is no longer breastfeeding, staff must enter the date breastfeeding ended and update the infant breastfeeding frequency on the infant's participant page prior to issuance.

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III. Breastfeeding

- A. Fully Breastfeeding – For a breastfeeding woman, whose infant(s) does not receive any infant formula from WIC (assumed to be fully breastfeeding their infants)
- B. Partially Breastfeeding- For a partially breastfeeding woman, whose infant(s) receive formula from WIC in amounts that do not exceed the maximum allowance for the partial food packages.
 - 1. This package is available in the birth month, however, staff should encourage women who are mostly breastfeeding to take the Fully Breastfeeding package.
 - 2. The infant will receive up to approximately a half package of formula.
 - 3. Every effort must be made to promote breastfeeding. Staff must encourage and support breastfeeding and use positive language when discussing breastfeeding. A breastfeeding woman who chooses the “Partially” breastfeeding food package in the birth month should be counseled according to Policy BF 1.0.
- C. Some Breastfeeding – for a woman up to six months postpartum whose infant(s) receives more than the maximum amount of formula allowed for partially breastfed infants.
 - 1. The infant must receive a formula package that is customized to reflect the quantity of formula needed as determined by the Certifying Authority (CA) or the WIC Certification Specialist (WCS) after discussing with the mother and estimating the needs of the infant. The CA or WCS will issue up to the maximum amount of formula allowed and must not automatically issue the maximum amount.
 - 2. Every effort must be made to encourage and support breastfeeding. A breastfeeding woman who chooses the “Some” Breastfeeding food package in the birth month should be provided extra breastfeeding support and encouraged to choose

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the Fully or Partially Breastfeeding Food Package for advanced issuance months.

3. A breastfed infant who receives less than the maximum amount of formula at initial issuance during the birth month may return to the clinic to receive up to the maximum amount of formula within that month. For example, if 5 cans of powder formula are uploaded to the economic unit's EBA, the breastfeeding woman can return within the same month to receive the maximum amount allowed of formula.
 4. The participant who is receiving the Some Breastfeeding Food Package is no longer eligible to receive WIC foods when she is six months postpartum but does continue to receive breastfeeding support including peer or lactation consultant counseling, breast pumps and participant-centered nutrition education, up to one year postpartum.
- D. When a breastfeeding woman requests formula or an increase in the amount of formula she receives, staff must:
1. Provide breastfeeding counseling according to [BF:01.0 Breastfeeding Promotion and Support Standards](#) Procedure III. D.
 2. Inform the woman that she will not be eligible to receive any food benefits after six months postpartum with the "Some" breastfeeding package but will be eligible to receive breastfeeding support.
- IV. Non-breastfeeding Postpartum
- A. The Postpartum food package is for women up to six months postpartum who are not breastfeeding their infants.
 - B. The infant must receive the appropriate formula package determined by the CA or the WCS.
- V. Situations involving a non-birth woman who is providing breastmilk, surrogacy, or a woman whose infant is adopted.

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- A. There can be only one breastfeeding woman per WIC infant
- B. A non-birth woman providing breastmilk to a WIC infant may qualify as a breastfeeding woman, for example an adoptive mother.
- C. If an adoptive mother is providing breastmilk to the infant, the adoptive mother and the infant will be the dyad in the MIS. The infant will not receive a food package unless the adoptive family qualifies and enrolls the infant in WIC.
- D. If a surrogate or a mother whose infant is adopted by another family expresses her breastmilk and provides the milk to the WIC infant:
 - 1. She must be certified as a breastfeeding woman and issued the appropriate breastfeeding food package.
 - 2. She will not be linked to the infant in the MIS.
- E. If a surrogate or a mother whose infant was adopted by another family provides breastmilk to a milk bank, she must be certified as a postpartum woman if it has been less than 6 months since delivery.
- F. Local agencies may contact the state agency for additional guidance in these situations.